



Website Briefing Document

Based on a Comparative Analysis of five IHI Prohct Websites

Version Control & History of Changes

Version	Date	Status	Owner
v1.0	May 2026	Draft for Review	GUIDE-AI WP07 Lead

1. Purpose & Scope

This document provides a structured briefing for the development of the official GUIDE-AI project website. It synthesises insights from a comparative analysis of five IHI project websites (<https://www.liveraim.eu/>; <https://ligand-ai.org/>; <https://euroheartpath.eu/>; <https://ihi-project-comfort.com/>; <https://www.inno4vac.eu/>) identifies best practices to adopt, patterns to adapt, and approaches to avoid — specifically through the lens of minimising maintenance effort while maximising clarity and scientific credibility.

Project Context

GUIDE-AI is an IHI-funded European research project developing LLM-based "Guideline Navigators" in chronic disease management (heart failure, chronic kidney disease, COPD, asthma + an exploratory subset in IBD). The website serves as the primary public-facing communication channel for scientific, clinical, and policy audiences across the consortium's partner countries.

2. Website Goals

Primary Goals

- Communicate the GUIDE-AI project mission, scientific approach, and progress clearly to diverse audiences (researchers, clinicians, regulators, public).
- Communicate the GUIDE-AI's impact to society in lay language.
- Serve as a credible, professional public presence aligned with IHI grant communication requirements.
- Minimise ongoing maintenance burden — content updates should be fast, low-effort, and not require developer involvement.

Secondary Goals

- Facilitate consortium member visibility (partner logos, institutional links).

- Provide a repository for public deliverables, publications, and news.
- Support dissemination activities: events, conferences, social media cross-linking.

3. Benchmarking: Analysed Websites

The following five project websites were reviewed and evaluated for structure, content, platform choice, maintenance model, and design quality:

Website	Platform	☑ Adopt	⚠ Adapt / Reconsider	✗ Avoid
Inno4Vac inno4vac.eu	Wix	Clear project structure; "At a Glance" summary box; dedicated subtopic pages; active news blog; strong use of visual hierarchy	Over-nested navigation (3 levels); Wix limits SEO & portability; heavy reliance on visual builder = layout lock-in	Excessive governance sub-pages rarely updated; "How to become a partner" page = unnecessary maintenance overhead
LiverAIM liveraim.eu	WordPress	WordPress = easy content updates by non-developers; social media icons in header; multi-language pages; embedded YouTube video; simple, clean homepage with Problem/Solution structure	Multilanguage pages are duplicated static content = high maintenance; survey link felt out-of-place; "Reserved Area" login visible to public	Static language copies (8 languages) without a proper CMS translation plugin = high duplication risk
LIGAND-AI ligand-ai.org	Unknown (minimal render)	N/A — website did not render content at time of review	N/A	N/A — Cannot be assessed; serves as cautionary example of a project website going dark or being inaccessible
EuroHeartPath euroheartpath.eu	WordPress + Elementor	Strongest visual design of all five; animated key stats (35 partners, 18 studies, 10 countries); interactive multi-year roadmap timeline; EU/IHI logo acknowledgement footer; embedded consortium partner map; short tagline hero text	Heavy Elementor reliance = slow page load; embedded video files (not YouTube) = large assets; partner list risks going stale	Hosted MP4 videos instead of streaming = poor performance; partner map as static PNG loses impact quickly as consortium grows
Project-COMFORT ihi-project-comfort.com	WordPress	Lean, focused navigation (5 items); Information Repository = practical public deliverable hub; clean Work Packages page; sustainability messaging (only 2 in-person meetings); Bluesky + LinkedIn social links	"Information Repository" label may confuse external visitors; no visual project summary on homepage	51-partner consortium rendered as plain text list = overwhelming; no visual hierarchy on partner page

4. Platform Recommendation

Recommended Platform: WordPress (self-hosted or managed)

WordPress is used by LiverAIM, EuroHeartPath, and Project-COMFORT — all three demonstrate that non-technical team members can update content without developer help. It offers a rich plugin ecosystem (news/blog, multilingual if needed, form handling), strong SEO, full data portability, and wide agency/freelancer support. Avoid Wix (lock-in, poor portability) and custom-built solutions (high maintenance cost).

Theme / Page Builder

- Use a lightweight theme such as Astra, GeneratePress, or **Hello Elementor (the EuroHeartPath base)** paired with a page builder for the homepage only.
- Inner pages (News, Partners, Deliverables) should be standard WordPress post/page templates — not built in a visual builder — to ensure easy editing.
- Avoid heavy premium themes with dozens of features that are never used; they add update overhead.

Hosting

- Choose a managed WordPress host (e.g. Kinsta, WP Engine, or SiteGround) or the institution's own server if IT support is available.
- **Ensure the .eu domain is secured and auto-renewed well in advance (LIGAND-AI serves as a cautionary example).**

5. Recommended Site Structure

Keep navigation flat — maximum two levels. Based on the benchmark analysis, the following structure balances completeness with low maintenance:

Page	Sub-Pages (max 1 level)	Content Notes
Home	—	Hero tagline + project summary; key stats (partners, diseases, countries); IHI/EU logo strip; latest news teaser (3 items); call-to-action button
About	Background Objectives Approach	Problem statement; GUIDE-AI solution; IHI grant info; funding acknowledgement
Work Packages	—	One card/section per WP with lead partner; can be a single page with anchor links
Consortium	Partners Governance	Logo grid with institution names and country flags; governance structure (can be a simple org chart image)
Results	Publications Deliverables News	Publications list (auto-fetched if using a DOI plugin or Zotero embed); public deliverables PDF library; news/blog posts
Events	—	Upcoming and past events; conference appearances; webinars (embed or link to recordings)
Contact	—	Central email address; social media links (LinkedIn, Bluesky); optional newsletter sign-up

6. Homepage Design Guidelines

The **homepage is the only page that justifies premium visual investment**. It should convert a first-time visitor into an informed supporter within 30 seconds.

Hero Section (above the fold)

- One bold, jargon-free tagline (e.g. "AI-powered guidance for chronic disease management").
- One sentence elaboration + one CTA button ("Learn about the project").
- Project/consortium logo on a clean background — no full-width video autoplay (performance cost, accessibility issues).

"At a Glance" Stats Block — adopt from Inno4Vac & EuroHeartPath

- 3–4 animated counters: number of partners, target diseases, countries, project duration.
- This is the single highest-impact design element across all five benchmarked sites and can be built with any standard WordPress plugin.

Problem / Solution Block — adopt from LiverAIM

- Two-column layout: The Clinical Challenge on the left, The GUIDE-AI Approach on the right.
- Use icons or simple illustrations rather than stock photos — lower licensing overhead, faster loading.

Latest News Feed — adopt from Inno4Vac & LiverAIM

- Automated feed of the 3 most recent posts — zero maintenance once configured.
- Do not manually curate this section; rely on WordPress's native post query.

Funding Acknowledgement Footer — adopt from EuroHeartPath

- IHI JU logo, EU flag, and required legal disclaimer text should appear on every page in the footer.
- Confirm exact wording with the GUIDE-AI grant agreement — failure to comply is a reportable issue.

7. Content Strategy & Maintenance Model

Feature / Element	Recommendation	Rationale
News / Blog	☑ Adopt	Simple WordPress posts. Assign 1 person per partner to submit items; editor reviews before publish. Highest ROI for keeping site alive.
Events calendar	☑ Adopt	Use The Events Calendar (free WordPress plugin). Auto-archives past events. Zero ongoing dev needed.

Feature / Element	Recommendation	Rationale
Publications list	✅ Adopt	Use a DOI-based plugin (e.g. Academic Bibliographies, or Zotero embed via shortcode). Auto-formats citations. Far less work than manual HTML tables.
Public deliverables	✅ Adopt	Upload PDFs to WordPress Media Library; link from a simple table on the Deliverables page. One row per deliverable — easy to add without touching code.
Partner logos	⚠️ Adapt	Use a logo grid plugin (e.g. Logo Carousel). Adding/removing a partner = upload logo + one click. Avoid hard-coding logos into page templates (Inno4Vac mistake).
Consortium map	⚠️ Adapt	EuroHeartPath's static PNG map looks impressive but goes stale. Use a free MapBox or Google Maps embed instead, or a simple Flourish.studio embed for a more dynamic look at no cost.
Video content	⚠️ Adapt	Always embed via YouTube or Vimeo — never host MP4 files directly (EuroHeartPath anti-pattern). Reduces hosting costs and improves loading speed globally.
Multilingual content	❌ Avoid	LiverAIM's 8 static language copies are a maintenance nightmare. If multilingual content is required by IHI, use WPML or Polylang plugin. Otherwise, English-only is the standard for IHI project websites.
Reserved area / login	❌ Avoid	Keep the internal collaboration space on a separate platform (SharePoint, Confluence, Google Drive). Public website + password-protected areas create confusion and are never well maintained (LiverAIM example).
"How to become a partner"	❌ Avoid	Inno4Vac has this page; it is likely never read and creates expectation management issues. Omit for GUIDE-AI.
Autoplay background video	❌ Avoid	Performance cost, accessibility issues (WCAG), and adds no information. Skip it.
Excessive governance pages	❌ Avoid	General Assembly, Steering Committee sub-pages (Inno4Vac model) are rarely updated and confuse external visitors. Summarise governance in one section of the About page.

8. Technical Requirements

Performance

- Target Google PageSpeed score > 80 (mobile). Validate after launch.
- Use a caching plugin (WP Rocket or W3 Total Cache) from day one.
- Compress all images before upload (use Squoosh or ShortPixel plugin).

Accessibility

- Aim for WCAG 2.1 AA compliance — required for publicly funded EU projects.
- All images must have alt text. All videos must have captions or transcripts.

SEO

- Install Yoast SEO or Rank Math plugin — handles metadata, sitemaps, and social sharing previews automatically.
- Set up Google Search Console and submit sitemap within 2 weeks of launch.

Security & Maintenance

- Enable automatic WordPress core and plugin updates.
- Schedule automated weekly backups to off-site storage.
- Assign one technical contact responsible for plugin updates and SSL certificate renewal.

9. Content Population Checklist

The following items must be prepared before or immediately after launch:

Content Item	Status	Responsible
Project tagline and 100-word project description (EN)	☐ To do	Communication WP lead
Project logo (SVG + PNG, transparent background)	Done	PMO
Partner logos (all, high-res, transparent background)	☐ To do	All partners
Grant agreement number and IHI acknowledgement text	☐ To do	PMO
Work Package descriptions (1 paragraph each)	☐ To do	WP leads
Key project facts (start date, end date, budget, countries, partners)	☐ To do	PMO
Consortium coordinator contact email	☐ To do	Coordinator
Social media handles (LinkedIn page, Bluesky if applicable)	☐ To do	Communication WP lead
First 3 news posts (launch announcement, kick-off meeting, project overview)	☐ To do	Communication WP lead
IHI/EU funding acknowledgement footer text (exact from grant)	☐ To do	PMO
Privacy Policy and Cookie Policy pages (GDPR)	☐ To do	Legal / Coordinator institution
Domain registration confirmed and auto-renewal enabled	☐ To do: re-check	IT / Communication WP lead

10. Suggested Development Timeline

Phase	Duration	Milestones
Phase 1 Planning	2 weeks	Domain confirmed; hosting selected; sitemap and wireframes approved by PMO; content checklist distributed to partners
Phase 2 Development	3–4 weeks	WordPress installed; theme configured; homepage built; all inner page templates set up; placeholder content in place
Phase 3 Content	2–3 weeks	Real content populated; partner logos uploaded; all pages reviewed by WP leads; SEO metadata set; cookie/privacy policy live
Phase 4 Launch	1 week	Final QA (mobile, desktop, accessibility check); Google Search Console submitted; social media announcement; internal team walkthrough for content editors

Phase	Duration	Milestones
Phase 5 Ongoing	Continuous	News posts (at minimum monthly); event updates; deliverable uploads after each reporting period; annual design review

11. Open Decisions for Orgateam

- Domain name: Confirm the exact domain (registered domains: ihi-guide-ai.com; ihi-guide-ai.eu; ihi-guide-ai.net; guide-ai.de / alternatives: guideai-project.eu / already blocked domains are marked with a red "X" in the figure below) and register immediately.

Select all names required and click Register

Domain	Available	Register	Investigation To Acquire
guide-ai.cn	✓	☐	
guide-ai.co.uk	✓	☐	
guide-ai.com	✗		☐
guide-ai.com.br	✓	☐	
guide-ai.de	✓	☐	
guide-ai.es	✓	☐	
guide-ai.eu	✗		☐

- Social media strategy: Will GUIDE-AI maintain a LinkedIn project page and/or Bluesky account? **Assign ownership before launch.**
- News frequency: Agree on a minimum posting frequency (recommended: at least 1 post per month) and nominate a news coordinator. Integrated these activities in the communication plan.
- Internal collaboration: Confirm that internal project management tools (SharePoint, etc.) are entirely separate from the public website — no "reserved area" on the public site.
- Design budget: Determine whether a freelance web developer or an agency is commissioned. Provide this briefing document as the RFP basis.
- Cookie consent: Confirm with the coordinator institution's legal team what tracking (if any) is permitted. A simple "Accept / Reject" cookie banner is sufficient for a project website.

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This document is prepared for internal use by the GUIDE-AI WP07 Lead.